AFRICAN SOLIDARITY CIVIC ORGANISATION (ASCO)
Registered NPC: 2026/521895/08
SARS Approved PBO: 930092287

+27 76 757 5773
www.africansolidaritycivic.org

CORPORATE CSI PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

Richards Bay Industrial Development Zone Company (RBIDZ) × ASCO

Richards Bay Community Coastal and Environmental Action Project

Requested CSI investment: R100,000

Proposed implementation area: Richards Bay and a mutually agreed disadvantaged community or public-benefit site within the Greater King Cetshwayo District Municipality, subject to local permissions and RBIDZ approval.

Prepared: October 2026

Confidential proposal for corporate CSI / ESG consideration. This document presents a proposed partnership and does not represent an award, endorsement, existing partnership or company commitment.

Executive summary

ASCO is seeking a strategic corporate CSI partnership with **Richards Bay Industrial Development Zone Company (RBIDZ)** to support a measurable public-benefit initiative: **Richards Bay Community Coastal and Environmental Action Project**. The proposed request is **R100,000**, to be applied to direct programme delivery, participation access, safety, learning materials, monitoring and accountable reporting.

ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.

> **The proposal in one sentence:** Richards Bay Community Coastal and Environmental Action Project in Richards Bay and a mutually agreed disadvantaged community or public-benefit site within the Greater King Cetshwayo District Municipality, subject to local permissions and RBIDZ approval., benefiting Residents and community volunteers in a disadvantaged King Cetshwayo community, with priority for youth, schools and local community organisations participating in environmental stewardship and practical skills activities; final beneficiary profile to be agreed with RBIDZ and relevant local authorities. through a locally designed, monitored and reportable intervention aligned with Richards Bay Industrial Development Zone Company (RBIDZ)'s publicly documented priorities, subject to the company's confirmation of eligibility and application requirements.

What ASCO is requesting
R100,000 in CSI support, or a partial/in-kind contribution structured with the company.

What the funding would enable
Direct activities, participation access, safe delivery, community materials, monitoring and a close-out report.

About ASCO

ASCO is a community-focused civic organisation promoting social justice, community development, active citizenship, African unity, environmental sustainability, inclusion and sustainable public-benefit action. ASCO works through advocacy, education, grassroots initiatives, humanitarian and community-development activities, partnerships and practical interventions.

ASCO is governed by four Directors. The Board governs and Executive Management manages. ASCO maintains governance, donation, safeguarding, financial-management, data-protection, monitoring and reporting instruments for responsible partnership administration.

ASCO's primary contact for this proposal is:

Mr. Bhekisisa (Mdu) Shandu
Executive Director
African Solidarity Civic Organisation (ASCO)
PBO Reference: 930092287
Tel: +27 76 757 5773
Website: https://www.africansolidaritycivic.org/

The proposed project

Project title
Richards Bay Community Coastal and Environmental Action Project

Implementation period
Proposed 6–12 month pilot, with final schedule agreed after eligibility, baseline and permissions are confirmed.

Location
Richards Bay and a mutually agreed disadvantaged community or public-benefit site within the Greater King Cetshwayo District Municipality, subject to local permissions and RBIDZ approval.

Target beneficiaries
Residents and community volunteers in a disadvantaged King Cetshwayo community, with priority for youth, schools and local community organisations participating in environmental stewardship and practical skills activities; final beneficiary profile to be agreed with RBIDZ and relevant local authorities.

Proposed outputs and targets

The following are proposed planning targets, not completed results. Final targets should be agreed with the company after baseline assessment, budget confirmation and any required stakeholder permissions.

- Proposed: engage 100 local residents, including youth, in environmental-awareness and practical stewardship sessions.
- Proposed: deliver 4 community environmental action days focused on litter reduction, coastal/public-space care or another locally approved activity.
- Proposed: remove and responsibly sort at least 2 tonnes of waste, subject to site conditions, permissions and verified measurement.
- Proposed: establish 2 community-led maintenance or monitoring groups with simple schedules and reporting tools.
- Proposed: provide 4 skills sessions covering waste minimisation, biodiversity/coastal care, safety and responsible disposal.
- Proposed: submit a close-out report with attendance records, before/after evidence, waste or activity measurements, expenditure records and lessons learned.

Expected outcomes

- Improved community participation and practical public-benefit action in the selected location.
- Improved access to relevant learning, environmental, inclusion, humanitarian or youth-development support, depending on the project design.
- Documented implementation evidence, beneficiary participation and lessons for continuation or scale-up.
- Clear accountability through expenditure records, activity updates, monitoring information and a close-out report.

Why this matters

The proposed intervention responds to a community-development need through the sequence **community need → practical intervention → measurable result**. The final baseline will verify the specific need, beneficiary profile, site conditions, permissions and appropriate indicators before implementation.

ASCO will avoid overstating the problem or claiming results in advance. Where waste, participation, learning, environmental condition, referrals or other outputs are measurable, ASCO will use simple evidence tools such as attendance registers, baseline/endline checks, activity logs, photographs with consent, beneficiary feedback and expenditure records.

> **Evidence discipline:** All numbers in this proposal are either company-reported context from official sources or clearly labelled ASCO planning targets. No completed result, partnership or funding commitment is claimed.

Why Richards Bay Industrial Development Zone Company (RBIDZ)?

ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.

Verified company context

- RBIDZ states that its CSI investments are directed mainly to its areas of operation, particularly disadvantaged communities in the Greater King Cetshwayo District Municipality.
- RBIDZ lists skills development, integrated health and environmental programmes, community development, and arts/culture/sports development as CSI focus areas.
- RBIDZ says its CSI purpose is to equip communities with sustainable projects and skills to support empowerment and socio-economic development in the region.
- RBIDZ's sustainability page identifies waste and effluent management, water and energy conservation, biodiversity and land management, air-quality management, coastal management, and environmental compliance as relevant environmental themes; it also states that RBIDZ is ISO 9001 and ISO 14001 certified.
- The 2024/2025 official annual report says RBIDZ sets aside an annual budget for community development and reports CSI activity including agri-business training/implements, social relief, school support, tertiary bursaries, a house build, boreholes and awareness campaigns. These are reported past activities, not a commitment to ASCO.
- RBIDZ is situated in Richards Bay on South Africa's northern coast and describes itself as a designated Special Economic Zone in KwaZulu-Natal.

Company facts are drawn from official sources reviewed for this proposal. They describe public priorities or reported company activity; they are not promises of funding to ASCO.

Indicative project budget

The requested amount is allocated transparently across delivery and accountability categories. The budget is indicative and should be refined with the company after the implementation site, beneficiary profile, quotations and eligible-cost rules are confirmed.

Budget category	Indicative amount	Use
Direct programme implementation	R60,000	Core activities, local delivery inputs and community implementation for the proposed project.
Participant transport and access	R8,000	Reasonable access support to enable participation, subject to eligibility and records.
Safety equipment and participant welfare	R6,000	PPE, first aid, safeguarding, water/refreshments and safe participation requirements.
Educational and mobilisation materials	R8,000	Learning resources, community mobilisation and accessible communication.
Monitoring, evaluation and reporting	R7,000	Baseline, attendance, outcome tracking, documentation and close-out reporting.
Volunteer/project coordination	R7,000	Scheduling, volunteer support, stakeholder coordination and implementation management.
Reasonable administration	R4,000	Reasonable project administration directly attributable to delivery; no inflated overheads.
Total requested CSI investment	**R100,000**	**Equals the proposed request.**

Administration is limited to a reasonable project share. ASCO will not promise audited financial statements unless they are available; it will provide appropriate project expenditure records and supporting documentation.

Partnership options

Option A — Full project funding
Company funds the proposed project at R100,000, subject to approval and agreement.

Option B — Partial project funding
Company contributes a defined portion of the budget, with scope and outputs adjusted transparently.

Option C — Multi-phase partnership
Company supports a pilot followed by an agreed continuation or scale-up phase based on evidence.

In-kind or technical support
Where relevant, equipment, expertise, access or employee volunteering may complement cash support, subject to written agreement.

Accountability and reporting

ASCO will maintain appropriate records relating to funded activities and can provide, subject to agreed requirements:

- Project implementation updates
- Expenditure records and supporting documentation
- Attendance and participation information where appropriate and lawfully collected
- Photographs and activity evidence with appropriate consent
- Safeguarding and incident records where relevant
- Monitoring and outcome information
- Activity and close-out reports

ASCO will agree reporting frequency, eligible costs, procurement expectations, data protection, branding, acknowledgement and any site-access or technical requirements before implementation. Any use of company branding or recognition will be subject to written approval.

Initial contact route

Use RBIDZ's official general contact route: info@rbidz.co.za and +27 35 797 2600. The public CSI page directs enquiries to this contact, but no dedicated public CSI application form or application portal was found. ASCO may also provide its contact +27 76 757 5773 and https://www.africansolidaritycivic.org/ when making the enquiry.

ASCO welcomes an initial discussion to confirm whether the proposed project is within the company's current CSI/ESG remit, whether unsolicited proposals are accepted, what documents are required, and whether the full, partial or in-kind partnership option is most suitable.

Important conditions and open questions

- RBIDZ's CSI page states that profit-making organisations/companies, religious activities, political activities and labour-union activities are excluded from financial support.
- The public CSI page does not publish a grant application form, submission deadline, required documents, assessment criteria, or confirmation that unsolicited proposals are accepted.
- No public source reviewed confirms a current R100,000 funding window, a commitment to ASCO, or a partnership with ASCO.
- Project design should confirm whether the proposed environmental work requires municipal, landowner, coastal, environmental or other statutory permissions and should avoid implying that RBIDZ will provide technical approvals or in-kind support.
- RBIDZ's annual CSI budget runs from 1 April to 31 March, so timing and available funds should be confirmed directly.
- Section 18A approved | Effective 9 October 2026

These cautions are included to prevent overstatement. They should be resolved with the company before ASCO treats the proposal as eligible or finalises a submission budget.

Closing

ASCO believes meaningful social and environmental progress is achieved through collaboration between communities, civil society and responsible corporate partners. We invite **Richards Bay Industrial Development Zone Company (RBIDZ)** to join us in delivering measurable public-benefit impact through a carefully scoped and accountable partnership.

Mr. Bhekisisa (Mdu) Shandu
Executive Director
African Solidarity Civic Organisation (ASCO)
PBO Reference: 930092287
Tel: +27 76 757 5773
Website: https://www.africansolidaritycivic.org/

Official sources and verification links

Important company and programme information in this proposal was checked against the following official sources:

1. https://www.rbidz.co.za/index.php/corporate-profile/corporate-social-investment-csi
2. https://www.rbidz.co.za/index.php/corporate-profile/sustainability
3. https://www.rbidz.co.za/index.php/media-hub/annual-reports/annual-report-2024-2025-pdf/download
4. https://www.rbidz.co.za/
5. https://www.rbidz.co.za/index.php/contact-us

Source review and proposal preparation date: October 2026. Company information and application routes can change; ASCO should confirm current requirements before submission.